

Cole Plagens

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EDUCATION

University of Houston

Houston, TX

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics, GPA: 3.64

Dec. 2025

- Relevant Coursework: Database Systems, Software Engineering, Software Design, Data Science
- Dean's List Fall 2023 - Fall 2025

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, C++, SQL

Frameworks: ASP.NET Core, React, Node.js, Express.js

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Azure, Docker, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis

Developer Tools: Linux, Postman, VS Code, Jest, Vercel, Supabase

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

Jul. 2026

Amazon Web Services (AWS)

PROJECTS

Incident Monitoring Platform

Feb. 2026 – Mar. 2026

- Built a distributed monitoring platform using ASP.NET Core, RabbitMQ, Redis, and PostgreSQL to ingest and process 10,000+ simulated log events through RESTful APIs and asynchronous worker services
- Improved message throughput by 40% through RabbitMQ optimization, Redis caching, and fault-tolerant retry mechanisms.
- Developed integration and stress tests validating API endpoints and worker services under concurrent workloads exceeding 10,000 events.

Volunteer Management Platform

Sep. 2025 - Nov. 2025

- Built a full-stack volunteer management platform using Express.js, Node.js, and PostgreSQL for event coordination and volunteer management.
- Designed RESTful APIs with JWT authentication, email verification, and role-based access control for secure volunteer and administrator workflows.
- Optimized PostgreSQL queries and implemented automated volunteer-event matching by skills, availability, and urgency, improving backend reliability under concurrent load
- Deployed the application using Vercel, Render, and Supabase, and implemented Jest-based testing for backend endpoints and core application functionality.

Theme Park Management System

Jan. 2025 – Apr. 2025

- Led a team of five developers in building a full-stack system using React and ASP.NET to manage ticketing, ride data, and user accounts with role-based access
- Designed and optimized a relational MySQL database schema supporting ticketing, ride management, and user account workflows while maintaining data integrity across application operations
- Developed administrative dashboards with analytics for revenue and operational insights, integrating backend APIs and frontend components
- Deployed the application using Azure and Vercel, ensuring high availability and responsive performance in a production-like environment

EXPERIENCE

AI Evaluation Contractor

May 2026 – Present

Handshake (Contract)

Remote

- Evaluated and ranked large language model outputs based on correctness, clarity, and instruction following.
- Identified reasoning errors and edge cases while applying detailed evaluation rubrics across benchmark tasks.
- Supported AI benchmarking initiatives including *Hedgehog* and *StudentBench* through high-quality annotations and performance assessments.